

Compare seating design alternatives

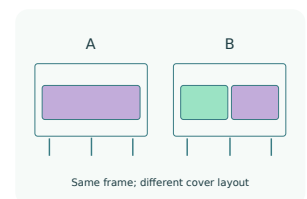
Appearance changes differ from changes affecting structure, support or usable seating. Compare two variants on one frame, then a third requiring construction review.

What you will accomplish

- Lock the baseline before appearance variants
- Identify changes that affect construction
- Tie the decision to a change register

Lock the baseline before appearance variants

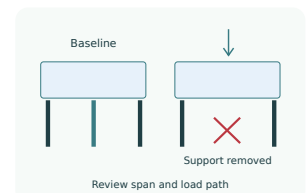
Fix the frame, support and effective seating dimensions, then compare A/B cover, colour or seam layouts. Record what changes and what stays fixed. A cover change still needs review of fabric direction, cleaning, stretch and tensioning; “appearance” is not an exemption from material specification. Compare using equivalent scale, viewpoint and sample presentation conditions.



Shared frame, explicit variables and reviewed cover properties.

Identify changes that affect construction

Variant C removes a centre leg for a lighter appearance. This changes load paths and the supported span even if upholstery remains identical. Arm width, back angle or joint changes can affect usable seating, forces and cutting patterns. Mark affected parts and require design/performance review before claiming equivalence. Do not compensate for a removed support by guessing a larger fastener.



A visual change can alter the load path and supported span.

Tie the decision to a change register

For each option record the reason, changed parts/materials, effects on cutting, upholstery and support, and required samples or reviews. Use consistent revision identifiers across drawings and schedules to prevent incompatible old/new parts being combined. Balance function, appearance, fabrication and serviceability, explicitly identifying outstanding checks rather than issuing an undifferentiated “approved” label.

Option	Impact and review
A/B	Cover / sample
C	Support / performance
R1	Drawings / specifications

Separate cover and support decisions

A revision-controlled change register connects choice to fabrication.

Worked case and decision

A and B share a centre-supported frame and differ in colour/seam layout. C removes the centre support and requires a construction change file and performance review. Selecting B's cover after sample review does not approve C's structure. Record the appearance decision separately from the support decision.

Decision: cover selection does not approve support removal.

Check understanding

Which change directly calls for a load-path review?

- Removing the centre leg
- Colour layout only
- Presentation background

Correct: Removing the centre leg. Removing support changes the span and load path.

Lesson questions

Is a cover change always purely cosmetic?

Not always. Review the new material's tensioning, cutting, cleaning and sample requirements.

Practice

Submit two same-frame appearance options and a support-changing third option, with an impact register and separate approval conditions.

A/B baseline

C support impact

Revision and decision register

Review your work against the criteria. Saving it does not constitute technical project approval.

- Appearance/construction separated
- Affected parts listed
- Outstanding checks remain explicit